

device, it lasted around 4-5 hours. When left idle, the device will easily last more than a day. So if you are planning to travel with it and want to keep it in your backpack on standby, you won't have to worry about the battery running out if you want to pull it out for a short session before your upcoming or during the flight.

Coming to speakers, this is one area that surprised me the most. The dual speakers are loud, detailed, and super immersive. I got scared while playing Silent Hill f, adrenaline pumping-level excited during Forza Horizon 5 and super relaxed while playing Ori and the Will of the Wisps. Even in an office environment, I could easily enjoy my games and back at home in my room, the speakers filled the room.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

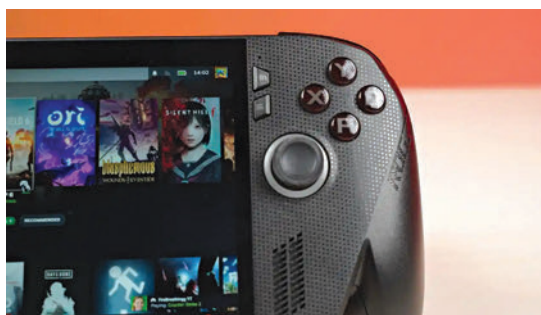
When you talk about gaming experience on-the-go, the ROG Xbox Ally X stands tall. Powered by AMD Ryzen AI Z2 Extreme, the device can handle even modern titles that are power hungry.

In the newly-launched Battlefield 6, I averaged around 50 fps at 1080p on medium settings during training. When I finally entered a match, the FPS hovered around 40 and the experience was stable.

Doom: The Dark Ages ran at roughly 20 fps at 1200x900 resolution on medium graphics, but enabling frame generation bumped it up to a much smoother 60 fps.

Silent Hill f saw 20 fps on high graphics with some stutters, but dropping to low settings improved both visuals and frame rates to about 30 to 35 fps. Meanwhile, a relatively less demanding game like Ori and the Will of the Wisps breezed through at around 140 fps on balanced settings.

I also enjoyed the adventurous world of Forza Horizon 5. It averaged around 100 FPS with high graphic settings and AMD's frame generation turned on. Every turn, every landscape and every



vehicle looked breathtaking here and I was quite immersed the whole time.

I also tried Black Myth: Wukong and the device did full justice to the incredibly detailed world. It managed to give me around 50 FPS mostly and even touched 60. The overall experience was quite smooth.

Talking about benchmarks, I used 3D Mark, Geekbench and Cinebench on the device. The scores are quite promising and show that this is a powerful device in the handheld segment.

Here's a quick look at some benchmark results:

- 3DMark Steel Nomad DX12: 601 points
- 3DMark Time Spy: 4104 points
- 3DMark Fire Strike: 9063 points
- Geekbench 6: 2803 (Single-core), 12768 (Multi-core)
- Cinebench 2024: 110 (Single-core), 544 (Multi-core)

Numbers aside, it's the real-world smoothness that impressed me. Games booted quickly, transitions were seamless, and the device rarely faltered during multitasking. Just to test its multitasking capability, I minimized Forza Horizon 5 and dared to open Microsoft Edge while running the game in the background. I was pleased to see that I could still browse comfortably.

THERMALS AND SOFTWARE

After a few hours of gaming, the Ally X felt warm but never alarmingly hot. This means that the internal cooling system is doing a fine job – air constantly pushes out through the vents, and while the exhaust air is scalding, the body itself remains fairly cool to the touch.

On the software side, it runs Windows, which means any PC gamer will feel right at home. Touch controls work well for navigation, but what I really liked was the dedicated Xbox mode. One button press launches the Xbox app, where you can access all your games and control the device entirely using joysticks – no need to touch the screen.

VERDICT

At around ₹1,15,000, the ROG Xbox Ally X is a luxury gadget that has nailed the concept of portable PC gaming. Sure, cheaper substitutes exist, but for those who can afford it, this is a superb fusion of console simplicity and PC power – a handheld that truly feels like an Xbox you can carry anywhere.

–Divyanshi Sharm

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: AMD Ryzen AI Z2 Extreme | NPU: AMD XDNA | GPU: AMD Radeon | RAM: 24 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 1 TB PCIe 4.0 NVMe M.2 SSD | Display: 7-inch 1080p IPS | Controls: View button, Menu button, L & R Hall Effect analog triggers, L & R bumpers, D-pad, Command Center button, Armoury Crate button, A B X Y buttons, 2 x assignable grip buttons, Thumbsticks: 2 x full-size analog sticks | Ports: 1x 3.5mm Audio Jack, 1x USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-C support Displayport, 1x Type C support USB 4, 1x UHS-II microSD card reader | Battery: 80Whrs | Power Supply: TYPE-C, 65W AC Adapter | OS: Windows 11

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